

Mahjong 麻將 *májiàng*

GOAL Be the first to assemble a winning hand — **4 melds + 1 pair** (14 tiles) — by drawing tiles or claiming others' discards.

01 · Tiles The deck 牌 *pái*

34 unique designs × 4 copies = **136 tiles**. Three numbered suits 1–9, plus four winds and three dragons (the "honor" tiles).

萬 Characters

Wàn — "ten thousand".
Numbered 1–9.

條 Bamboo

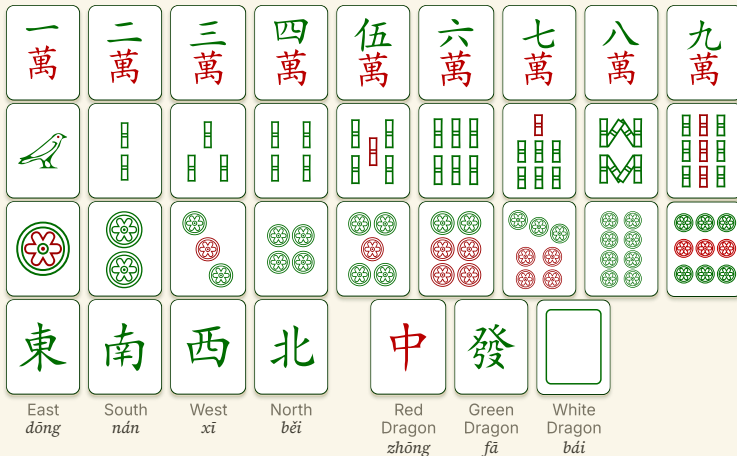
Tiáo — sticks. The 1-bamboo is a bird.

餅 Dots

Bǐng — coins.
Numbered 1–9.

風·箭 Honors

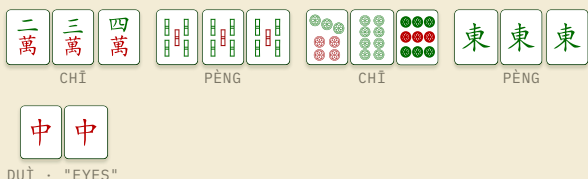
Winds · Dragons / Fēng · Jiàn. Can't be in a chí (3-in-a-row).



02 · Win How you win 胡 *hú*

A standard winning hand = **4 melds + 1 dui** = **14 tiles**. You hold 13; draw or claim a 14th tile that completes your hand, then declare *Hú*.

EXAMPLE COMPLETE HAND · 14 TILES



A "meld" is one of these:

吃 Chī 3 in a row · same suit



Honor tiles (winds, dragons) cannot form a chí.

碰 Pèng 3 of a kind · any tile



杠 Gàng 4 of a kind



Declaring a gàng earns one bonus tile from the dead wall.

對 Duì 2 of a kind · the "eyes"



Every winning hand has exactly one dui.

03 · Turn What you can do 招 *zhāo*

ON YOUR TURN — ONE MOVE

Draw 摸 *mō* · then discard

Take one tile from the wall — you now hold 14. Discard one face-up into the middle to return to 13.

IF: New tile makes you win → declare **Hú**, game ends.

IF: Complete 4 of one tile → option to declare a **concealed gàng**; if you do, reveal it and draw one bonus tile, then discard.

ON ANY PLAYER'S DISCARD — EVERY PLAYER WATCHES

When the player whose turn it is discards a tile, any player may interrupt and claim it. Choose one — **higher rank wins** if multiple players want it:

- 胡 Hú** ANYTIME · ANY SEAT
The tile completes your winning hand (4 melds + 1 dui). Game ends.
- 杠 Gàng** ANYTIME · ANY SEAT
Take it to make four of a kind. Reveal the meld face-up and draw one bonus tile, then discard.
- 碰 Pèng** ANYTIME · ANY SEAT
Take it to make three of a kind. Reveal the meld face-up, then discard.
- 吃 Chī** ONLY FROM THE PLAYER RIGHT BEFORE YOU
Take it to make 3 in a row, same suit. Reveal the meld face-up, then discard.

How play continues

- No one claims** → turn passes counter-clockwise to the next player on the discarder's right.
- After Pèng / Gàng / Chī** → claimer discards, then play continues with the player after them. Players in between are skipped.
- After Hú** → game ends.
- Wall empties with no winner** → game is a draw 荒莊 *huāng zhuāng*.

Concealed vs. exposed

Melds you build from your own draws stay concealed in hand. Melds claimed from a discard sit face-up.